

Işın Acun

Ph.D. Candidate in Marketing

WU Vienna

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Digital platforms & marketplaces · tax & tariff incidence · digital advertising · user-generated content · causal inference

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Marketing

2022 – 2027 (expected)

WU Vienna University of Economics and Business, Austria

Advisor: Prof. Dr. Nadia Abou Nabout.

M.Sc. in Economics

2019 – 2022

University of Mannheim, Germany

B.Sc. in Economics

2014 – 2019

Middle East Technical University (METU), Ankara, Turkey

Cum Laude. Minor in Business Administration. Exchange semester at the University of Groningen (2018–2019).

WORKING PAPERS

Acun, I., Kasinger, J., and Abou Nabout, N.

“Who Bears the Burden of Digital Service Taxes?”

Job Market Paper — revise & resubmit at Marketing Science

Digital service taxes (DSTs) were designed to make Big Tech pay. Using an advertiser-level Google Ads panel of 16,532 advertisers across 29 European countries, together with Google’s staggered rollout of DST surcharges, we show the tax is passed through near-completely to local advertisers: ad prices rise by 3.4%, almost exactly the 3.2% statutory rate, while quantities stay flat. This is the first causal estimate of DST incidence in digital advertising.

Abou Nabout, N., Acun, I., Kaiser, M., and Liaukonytė, J.

“Not so De Minimis: Tariffs and Cross-Border Trade on Online Marketplaces”

Revise & resubmit at Marketing Science

Exploiting the 2025 U.S. suspension of the \$800 *de minimis* duty-free rule as a natural experiment, we show the online marketplace shrinks by roughly 6%, mostly lost cross-border sales rather than redistribution to domestic sellers; foreign sellers lose 13–16% of weekly units sold.

Grzadziel, A., Acun, I., Brand, M. L., Ruckelshausen, S., and Abou Nabout, N.

“The Dupe-licity Effect: Does Viral User-Generated Content Help or Hurt Premium Brands?”

Work in progress — targeting Journal of Marketing / Journal of Marketing Research

Combining 500K+ TikTok videos, LLM-based product extraction with human validation, and difference-in-differences on retail sales panel data, we find viral “dupe” videos do not cannibalize premium brands’ revenue; instead they extend it by roughly three extra weeks of sales per product-country each year.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, Lisbon, Portugal <i>Not so De Minimis: Tariffs and Cross-Border Trade on Online Marketplaces</i>	2026
ZEW Conference on the Economics of ICT, Mannheim, Germany <i>Who Bears the Burden of Digital Service Taxes?</i>	2026
55th EMAC Annual Conference, Bath, United Kingdom <i>Who Bears the Burden of Digital Service Taxes?</i>	2026
INFORMS Marketing Science Conference, Washington, DC, USA <i>Who Bears the Burden of Digital Service Taxes?</i>	2025
3rd Workshop on Digital Markets (WDM), Rotterdam, Netherlands <i>Who Bears the Burden of Digital Service Taxes?</i>	2025
Mapping and Governing the Online World (MGOW) Conference, Ascona, Switzerland <i>Who Bears the Burden of Digital Service Taxes?</i>	2024
Doctoral Colloquium, 49th EMAC Annual Conference, Bucharest, Romania <i>Who Bears the Burden of Digital Service Taxes?</i>	2024
52nd EMAC Annual Conference, Odense, Denmark <i>The Moderating Role of Website Type on the Effect of Viewability on View-Throughs</i>	2023

GRANTS, AWARDS & CONSORTIA

Research Assistant Small Project Grant (PI) <i>WU Vienna</i> Project: “Digital Services Taxes in Advertising: Asymmetric Platform Pass-Through and Tax Incidence.”	2025
ISMS Doctoral Consortium, Participant <i>INFORMS Society for Marketing Science</i>	2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Digital Marketing Lab (B.Sc.), Instructor <i>WU Vienna</i> Five cohorts, each run with an industry partner: PwC, Willhaben, Signifikant, Goldbach Interactive, and NielsenIQ. Sole or co-instructor for up to 65 students per cohort.	2022 – 2025
Marketing Analytics (B.Sc.), Instructor <i>WU Vienna</i> Three cohorts.	2022 – 2025
Thesis Supervision <i>WU Vienna</i> 20+ Bachelor’s and Master’s theses on AI-generated content, retail media, viewability, and brand scandals.	2022 – present

ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

Teaching and Research Associate <i>Institute for Interactive Marketing & Social Media (IMSM), WU Vienna, Austria</i> Research on the economics of digital platforms (taxes, tariffs, user-generated content). Instructor for the Digital Marketing Lab and Marketing Analytics. Managing the institute’s social media channels and coordinating Digital Marketing Lab industry partnerships.	02/2022 – present
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Research Assistant 09/2020 – 01/2022
ZEW – Leibniz Centre for European Economic Research, Mannheim, Germany
 International Finance and Financial Management department. Supported household-finance projects (pension insurance, financial literacy, expectations): literature reviews, survey data cleaning, and statistical analysis.

Teaching Assistant 02/2020 – 06/2020
University of Mannheim, Germany
 Master’s-level tutorials for Business Economics I & II; prepared problem-set solutions.

SERVICE & SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

Contributing Author, IJRM Newsletter 2025 – present
International Journal of Research in Marketing
[“Crossing Borders: A Field Report from EMAC Bath & Marketing Science Lisbon”](#) · [“Why AI-Generated Content Might Be the Best Marketing Decision You Haven’t Made Yet”](#) · [“Finding Privacy in a Crowd: The Where’s Waldo Effect in Marketing Analytics”](#) · [“When Customer Returns Evolve: The Hidden Cost of Customer Loyalty”](#) · [“Question the Default: How a Simple Fix Can Save Millions in Ad Spend”](#)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Intern, CEO’s Team 07/2019 – 09/2019
App Samurai, San Francisco, USA
 Market and competition analysis for the Series A funding round; profitability dashboards on Amazon QuickSight.

Research Intern 07/2018 – 08/2018
Economic Policy Research Foundation of Turkey (TEPAV), Ankara, Turkey
 Data analysis and research on industry dynamics, Center of Innovation Studies.

Digital Marketer (part-time) 05/2017 – 03/2018
MarketoList, Turkey
 Social media management, marketing strategy, and lead generation.

SKILLS

Methods	Causal inference (staggered & synthetic DiD, event studies, IV), panel econometrics
Programming	R (advanced), Python, Stata, $\text{\LaTeX}$
Languages	Turkish (native), English (fluent), German (basic)